

THE DAY IN CONTEXT / 2026-08-24

Canonical Kubernetes 1.36 Release Requires Live Network Path Verification

Canonical Kubernetes 1.36 introduces routing changes and removes k8s-dqlite, requiring defenders to verify live network paths and datastore readiness.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Canonical Kubernetes 1.36 changes service routing, component versions, and datastore support. Defenders must verify live paths and inventory states rather than relying on version checks.

01

KUBERNETES UPGRADES

Canonical Kubernetes 1.36 Upgrade Changes Routing and Datastore

Canonical Kubernetes 1.36 removes kube-proxy on new clusters using Cilium, deprecates specific settings, and makes etcd the only supported built-in datastore.

WHY IT MATTERS Identical versions can have different packet paths and failure modes, making verification essential.

[Canonical Kubernetes Upgrades Need Network-Path Proof](#) ↗

THE OPERATING VIEW

What the day means for defenders

Operators must confirm current datastore backends before upgrading and test representative service flows, ingress policies, and telemetry coverage after deployment.

1

Verify live network paths and effective routing states after upgrades.

2

Confirm datastore backends before initiating cluster upgrades.

3

Test telemetry coverage and policy enforcement post-upgrade.

Every briefing in this digest

01 [Canonical Kubernetes Upgrades Need Network-Path Proof](#)

Read the full analysis

<https://shadowcontext.com/>